

Customer Quick Start

Field · Value

Document ID · DOC-008-CU

Version · 0.8.0-draft.1

Product version · v0.8.0 target; accepted behavior through v0.7.0

Status · Draft

Owner · Customer Experience Lead

Classification · Customer confidential — NDA required

Last reviewed · 2026-08-03

Purpose

Create your account, explore travel, request a quote, follow a booking, and get help safely in your first session.

Who should use this guide

New VirtCruise customers using their own records. Allow about 30–45 minutes. You need access to your email and the details VirtCruise asked you to provide.

Important: This guide is a desk reference, not the full procedure. It does not replace DOC-002 through DOC-007, DOC-009, or DOC-010. Status meanings always come from DOC-007.

Daily workflow

Sign in → Check messages/status → Complete one eligible action
→ Verify the result → Sign out on shared devices

Top 10 tasks

1. **Create an account.** Open **Create account**, enter your own accurate details, accept required terms, submit once, and note the check-your-email message.
2. **Verify email.** Open the newest VirtCruise verification message and use its link once. If it expired, request a new message rather than reusing it.
3. **Log in.** Use your email and password. Never share a password or verification/reset link, including with Support.
4. **Browse packages.** Compare destination, duration, inclusions, exclusions, pricing basis, terms, and availability wording. Public content may change until booking is confirmed.
5. **Request a quote.** Add the required services, travellers, dates, contact details, and requests; review the summary; submit once; retain the quote reference.
6. **Review and accept a quote.** Open **My Quotes**, check the current offer and terms, and use **Accept quote** only when available and correct. Acceptance does not itself confirm travel.
7. **Follow your booking.** Open **My Bookings**, use the booking reference, and read the current status. Use [DOC-007 customer-visible statuses](#) rather than guessing.
8. **Use Manual Finance.** Follow only the approved Finance contact instructions displayed for your currency and quote/invoice reference. Production Manual Finance does not provide self-service bank details or proof upload. A transfer is not confirmed until Finance verifies cleared funds.
9. **Use the Customer Portal.** Review your own quotes, bookings, finances, trips, profile, and notifications. A dashboard summary does not replace the detailed record.
10. **Get support.** Use the approved **Contact** or Support route. Give the relevant quote, booking, invoice, Payment, Receipt, or support reference—never a password, security code, full payment data, or proof file unless an approved secure flow asks for it.

Quick checklist

Start-of-day checklist

- [] Use a trusted device/network and the genuine VirtCruise address.
- [] Sign in to your own account and check the current detailed record.
- [] Keep the correct quote or booking reference ready.

Top task checklist

- [] Confirm you selected your own record.
- [] Read the current status and required action.
- [] Review dates, travellers, currency, amounts, and terms before submitting.
- [] Submit once, wait for the result, and save the customer-safe reference.
- [] Refresh the authoritative record before repeating an uncertain action.

End-of-day checklist

- [] Confirm your requested action appears in the relevant detailed record.
- [] Record any Support reference and next expected update.
- [] Sign out, especially on a shared device; close sensitive messages/documents.

Common mistakes

- Treating quote acceptance, an uploaded proof, a transfer, or a Receipt as Booking Confirmation.
- Reading a notification or dashboard card instead of the authoritative booking/Financial record.
- Submitting a quote or transfer twice when the first result is uncertain.
- Sending proof or sensitive data through ordinary email or messaging without an approved request.

Do's and don'ts

Things you should always do

- Keep references and compare currency, amount, dates, travellers, and outstanding balance.
- Contact VirtCruise when a status conflicts with a direct communication.

- Report suspected account compromise immediately through the approved Support route.

Things you must never do

- Share passwords, one-time codes, reset links, or another person's records.
- Use bank details from an old message or third party; Manual Finance supplies approved contact guidance, not self-service bank instructions.
- Assume DEPOSIT_PENDING means a booking is confirmed or that Finance lost your message.

Escalation

Issue · Owner · Escalate when · Do not escalate when

Quote, itinerary, availability · Consultant · Current quote is unclear, wrong, or cannot be accepted · You have not yet read the current quote/terms

Transfer, balance, Receipt · Finance · Reference is correct but authoritative Financial record is missing/wrong · You only just submitted and the stated processing step remains pending

Booking progression · Operations · Financial record and booking status conflict or travel is affected · The displayed status already explains the next action

Sign-in/reset · Support · Newest valid flow fails after one careful retry · A field message identifies a correction you have not made

Security/privacy · Security/Privacy via Support · Immediately for suspected compromise or another customer's data · Never investigate or forward suspicious content yourself

Support owns the customer conversation until handoff is acknowledged. Provide the minimum safe facts and what you observed; do not diagnose internal systems.

Screenshot placeholder

Screenshot required — Figure 1: Customer first-session route

Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile. Content: fictional account verification, My Quotes, and My Bookings states. Alternative text: Customer route from verified account to quote and booking detail. Dependency: approved customer capture environment; no live customer data.

Related manuals

- [DOC-002. Customer User Guide](#) — full customer procedures.
- [DOC-003. Operations Manual](#) — staff-owned operational boundaries.
- [DOC-004. Finance SOP](#) — controlled finance processing.
- [DOC-005. Support Playbook](#) — how Support handles requests.
- [DOC-006. Content Studio Guide](#) — how published package content is governed.
- [DOC-007. Status & Lifecycle Reference](#) — authoritative statuses and transitions.

Change history

Version · Date · Author · Change · Status

0.8.0-draft.1 · 2026-08-03 · Documentation Lead · Initial role Quick Start · Draft